

# Baptism Outline

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### Purpose

This outline helps leaders prepare and celebrate baptism rooted in Scripture. Baptism is an outward sign of an inward faith (Romans 6:3-4; Matthew 28:19-20).

### Before the service

- Meet with the candidate to explain the meaning of baptism and ensure they understand the gospel (Romans 10:9-10).
- Confirm a simple testimony: how they came to trust Christ and their desire to follow him.
- Practical checks: clothing, towel, witnesses, and the location for baptism.

### Service outline

#### 1) Welcome and brief explanation

- Read: Matthew 28:18-20 and explain baptism as a public declaration of following Jesus.

#### 2) Candidate testimony (2-3 minutes)

- Invite the candidate to briefly tell how they trusted Jesus.

#### 3) Scripture reading

- Recommended: Romans 6:3-4, Colossians 2:12, Acts 2:38

#### 4) Baptism act

- Perform baptism (immersion or pouring) with a short phrase such as: "[Name], I baptize you in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit." (Matthew 28:19)

#### 5) Prayer and welcome

- Pray for the new believer and welcome them into the church family.

### After the service

- Provide next steps: connect to a discipleship group, give a Bible reading plan, and assign a small-group mentor (Hebrews 10:24-25; 2 Timothy 2:2).

### Practical tips

- Keep the theology simple and Bible-centred. Emphasize repentance, faith, and new life in Christ. Celebrate, pray, and follow up with discipleship.